

QuantileCull V1.1 Pilot - User Guide & Reference Manual

Welcome to the **QuantileCull V1.1 Pilot Release**. QuantileCull is a high-performance, offline-first photo culling and selection desktop application designed for professional wedding, event, and sports photographers.

1. System Requirements

Recommended Hardware

- **Operating System:** Windows 10 or Windows 11 (64-bit).
- **Processor:** Intel Core i5/i7/i9 (8th Gen or newer) or AMD Ryzen 5/7/9.
- **Memory (RAM):** 8 GB minimum (16 GB or higher recommended for large shoots >5,000 photos).
- **Storage:** Solid State Drive (SSD) with at least 500 MB free space for application models, cache database, and temporary execution logs.

Supported File Formats

- **Metadata Reading:** Standard EXIF and IPTC data.
 - **Image Formats:** JPEG, PNG, TIFF, and common RAW formats (CR2, CR3, NEF, ARW) supported via local system codecs.
 - ***Note:** For optimal performance, culling against high-resolution JPEG previews embedded in RAW files is recommended.*
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2. Step-by-Step Activation

QuantileCull operates completely offline after a one-time activation handshake.

1. Ensure your PC is connected to the internet.
 2. Launch `QuantileCull_V1.1.exe`.
 3. Fill out the **Registration Card** with your professional details. This demographic data maps key usage to specific pilot photographer segments.
 4. Input your unique **Activation License Key** (e.g. QC-7H2D-KQ9P-XM4T).
 5. Click **Activate Now**. Once verified, a local encrypted file `qc_license.dat` is saved in your Local AppData folder, and the application unlocks. You may now disconnect from the internet; the app will continue to run completely offline.
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3. Explaining Culling Modes and Parameters

QuantileCull offers dual culling metrics:

1. Duplicate Detection Threshold (default: 85%):

- Compares image hashes to identify sequential bursts or duplicate poses.
- Increase this threshold (e.g., 90%) to group only identical frames.
- Decrease this threshold (e.g., 75%) to group wider, similar poses.

2. Aggressive Culling Fraction (Top N%):

- Automatically selects only the highest-scored photos in each burst. If set to 30%, only the top 30% sharpest, best-composed, open-eyed photos in each burst group will be marked as "Keep".
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4. Troubleshooting & FAQ

SmartScreen Blocked Launch

- **Issue:** Windows Defender flags the portable binary as unsigned.
- **Solution:** Click **More Info** on the SmartScreen dialog, then click **Run Anyway**.

Expiry Bar Warning

- **Issue:** A top warning bar displays: "Trial Ended. Contact QuantileCull for an Extended Evaluation License."
- **Explanation:** Your 30-day evaluation token has expired. The application has entered **Read-Only Mode**. You can still browse folders, view grids, and inspect historical culling scores. Running new scans or exporting photos is blocked until you click **Renew License** and input a fresh token.

Clock rollback detected warning

- **Issue:** A red warning bar blocks the UI with "License Verification Failed (System Clock Rollback Detected)".
 - **Explanation:** The app's tamper-protection detected that the system time was set backward to bypass the 30-day expiration check. The app will remain locked in Read-Only Mode until the system clock is synchronized to the current local time.
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5. Contact & Bug Reporting

To report a bug:

1. Relaunch the application. If a crash occurred, the app will display a prompt: "Unexpected Crash Detected. Would you like to send a crash report?"
2. Click **Send Crash Report** to upload the stack trace to our logs.
3. Alternatively, click the **Feedback** button in the header, describe your workflow, and click **Submit**.
4. Support email: quantilecull.support@gmail.com.